Hidden Sources & Label Reading

Eliminated foods hide in packaged foods, restaurant meals and supplements. A single slip won't ruin your progress, but repeated hidden exposures can keep symptoms simmering and make your reintroduction results confusing.

WHERE ELIMINATED FOODS HIDE

WATCH FOR	OFTEN HIDDEN IN
"Spices," "seasoning," "natural flavors"	Can include paprika, chili or seed spices. Jerky, meat sticks, rotisserie chicken, sausages, deli meats, broths, dressings.
Paprika / paprika extract	Used for color in salmon, bacon, chips, sauces, "smoked" flavors.
Potato starch / modified food starch	Shredded cheese substitutes, gluten-free baked goods, gravies, medications and supplement capsules.
Ashwagandha, capsicum, cayenne	Adrenal, stress, sleep, metabolism and "thermogenic" supplements.
Egg / albumin / lysozyme	Mayonnaise, baked goods, meatballs, battered foods, some supplements.
Soy lecithin, soybean oil	Chocolate, supplements, "avocado oil" mayo blends, restaurant cooking oil.
Sugar, cane juice, erythritol (including in "stevia" and "monk fruit" blends)	Bacon, smoked salmon, sausages, deli meats, coconut yogurt, broths, protein powders, electrolyte mixes.
Sunflower / safflower oil	Chips, "paleo" snacks, roasted vegetables at restaurants, dried fruit.
Tomato, chili	Worcestershire, BBQ, ketchup, salsa, taco seasoning, many soups.

The simple rule If a label lists an ingredient you don't recognize or can't verify, leave it on the shelf for now. The fewer ingredients, the better.

EATING OUT

- Order simple: grilled or roasted protein, plain steamed or roasted vegetables, a salad with olive oil and lemon.
- Ask for no seasoning except salt, cooked in olive oil (no butter or vegetable oil).
- Ask that no peppers, tomatoes, cheese or croutons be added.
- Bring your own coconut aminos or dressing if you like.